



How old were students when they left the Augusta Military Academy?

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Subtitle: May be shared

Context

The Augusta Military Academy was a notorious military academy located in Fort Defiance, Virginia. Founded in 1865, the military academy welcomed over 12,000 students over its lifespan until its doors officially closed in 1984. We have received a list of cadets that were enrolled in the AMA's program, and have used its features to create an easy to read analysis.

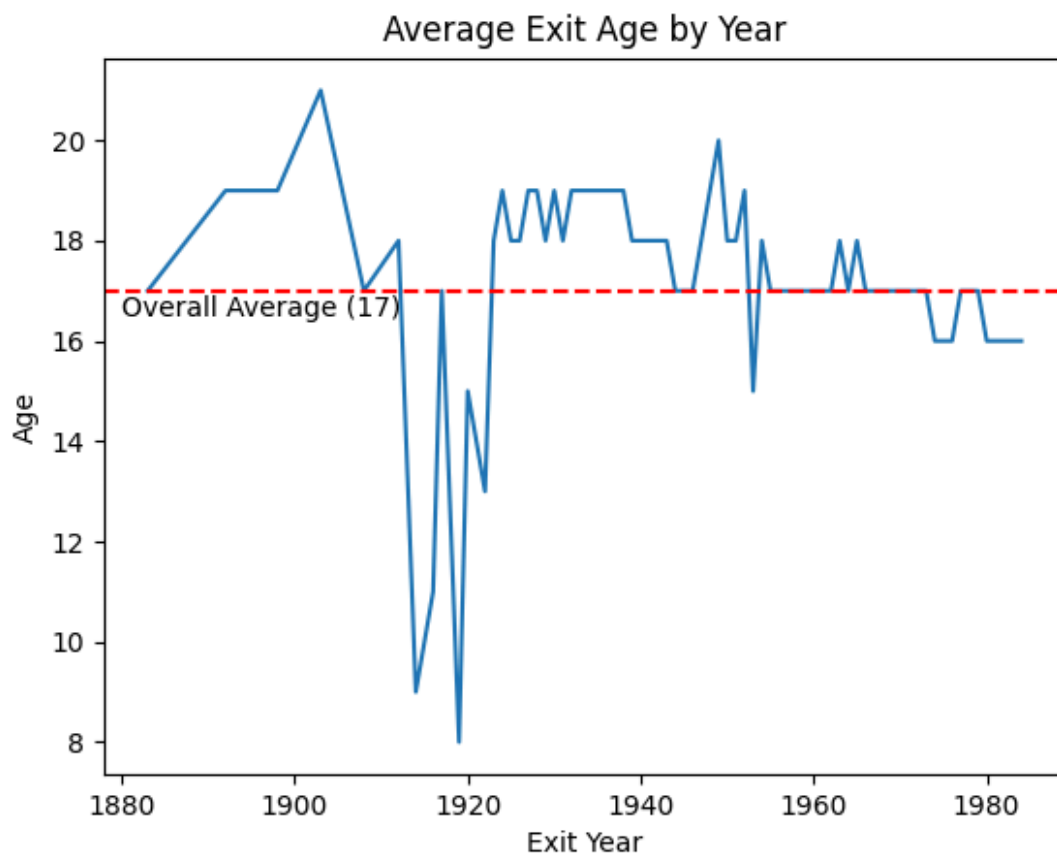
In our analysis, we took in a large data set that used fake names, thus being anonymized, to display a cadet's identifying information, such as their ID number, date of birth, and date of death. This data set was quite messy when we first received it, so we implemented a series of code to help clean it up so it was legible to be examined. Our program(s) were created for the purpose of identifying the age in which the cadet left the Augusta Military Academy program.

The original dataset consists of the last name, exit year, identification number, and dates and locations of birth and death of the cadet. All of these, with the exception of death dates and locations, were used in the cleaned dataset. For cleaning the original dataset, we made the assumption that the two-digit years started with "19".

Based on the first look of the data, we believed the average age for cadets to leave the academy would be 18. After analyzing and graphing the data, we discovered that the average age of cadets leaving the AMA was 17, not 18. We believe this is due to the fact that there are a large number of cadets, especially in the 1915 to the early 1920s, that left the academy at a young age, with the youngest being 7 and the oldest being 24.

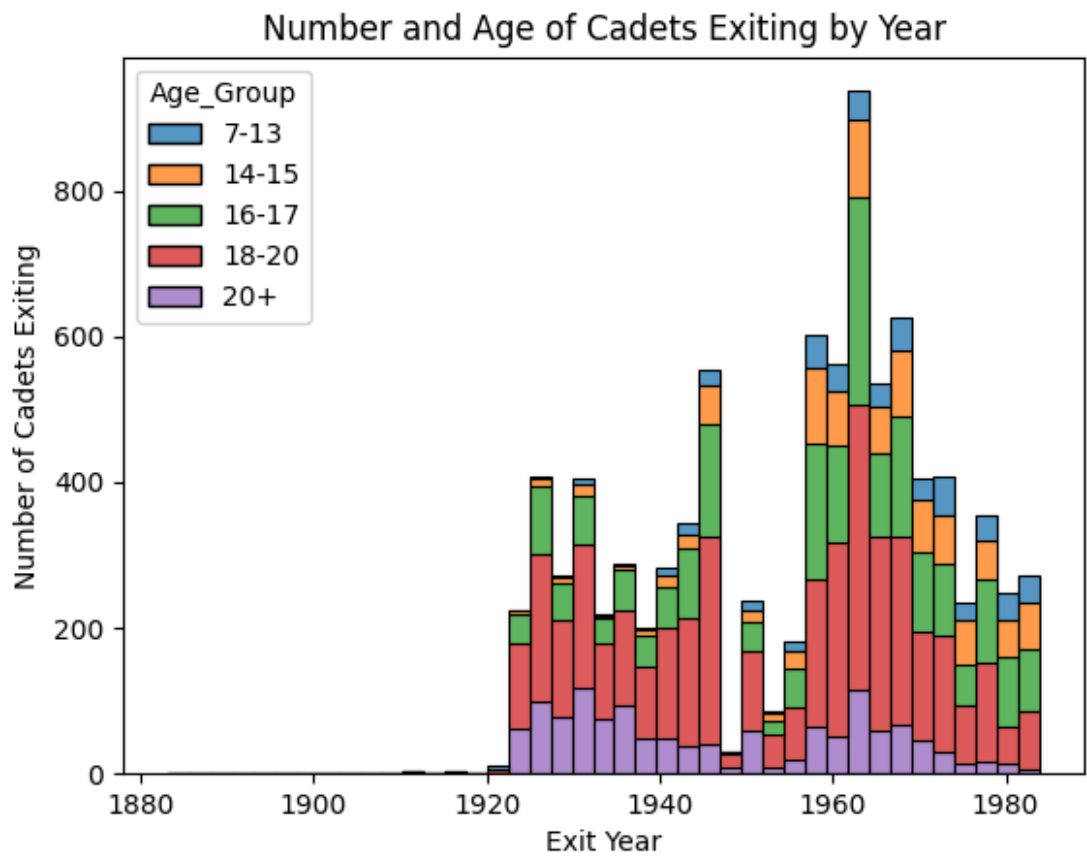
Visualizations

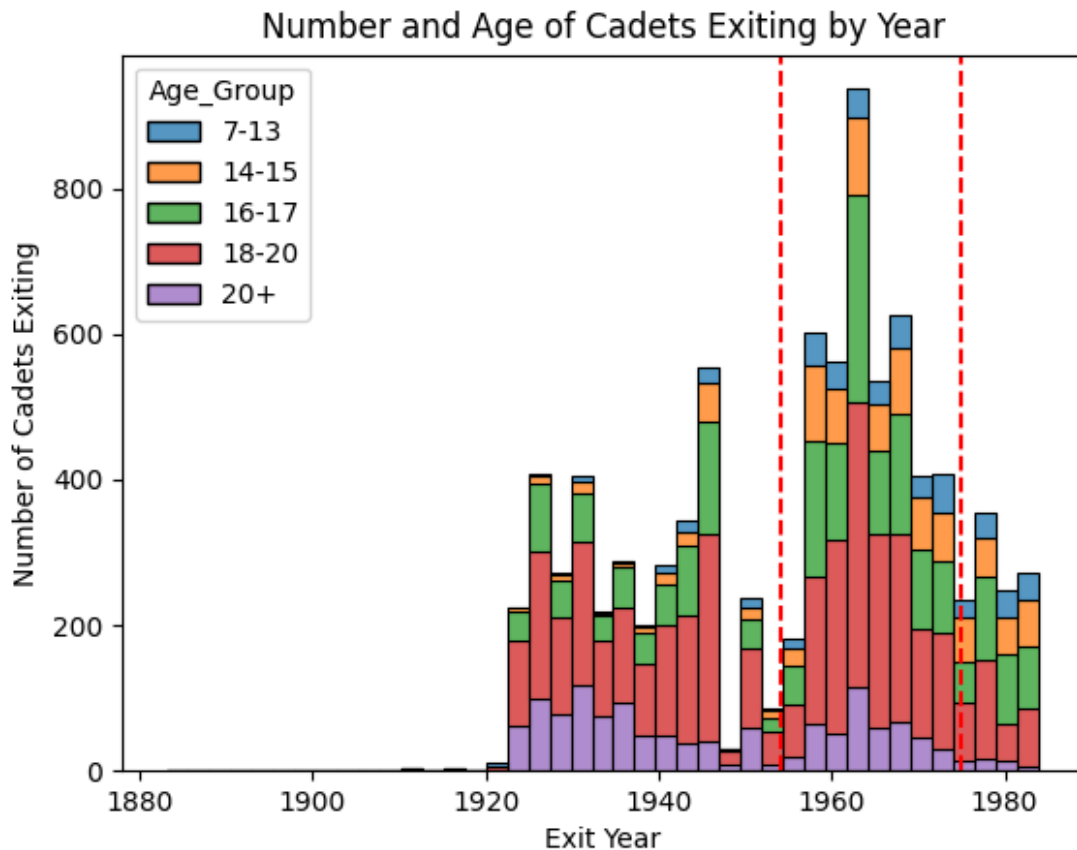
Average Cadet Exit Age by Year



The graph above shows the average age of cadets as they were leaving the academy. For this graph, we used a Python feature called Seaborn to display a line graph using a Pandas DataFrame to hold our data. As the graph shows, many of the cadets were 16 and older when they left. There was a period of time, from the 1910s to the 1920s, where there was a drastic decrease in the age of cadets when they left.

Number and Age of Cadets Exiting by Year





The two graphs above show the same information as the previous one, but in a different format. We also used Seaborn, as we did with the previous graph, but we utilized a histogram with the Pandas DataFrame rather than the line graph. We did this to help better represent which age groups in the data set were exiting in which time frame. As you can see, there was a large chunk of cadets leaving from the late 1950s until the mid 1960s, as we believe this is heavily influenced by the Vietnam War, which began in late 1954 and went until mid 1975. The peak of the Vietnam War was around 1968, which would explain why the highest peak in our graph(s) of exiting cadets was around that time.

Sincerely,

Rose Furr & Felicity Copenhaver